

BELGIUM

Model UN Research Dossier – Belgium

◆ Key Country Details Table

Detail	Information
Full Name	Kingdom of Belgium (Royaume de Belgique / Koninkrijk België / Königreich Belgien)
Short Form	Belgium
Capital	Brussels
Region (UN)	Western European and Other States
Government Type	Federal parliamentary constitutional monarchy
Head of State	King Philippe
Head of Government	Prime Minister Bart De Wever (as of March 2025)
Currency	Euro (EUR)
UN Member Since	27 December 1945
MUN Standing	Active participant in peacekeeping and human rights initiatives; member of various UN bodies; advocates for multilateralism and international law.

📖 General Book Recommendations

1. **"The Politics of Belgium"** – Marleen Brans
2. **"A Concise History of Belgium"** – Guy Vanthemsche
3. **"Belgium and Poland in International Relations 1830–1831"** – J.A. Betley
4. **"Boosting Skills for Greener Jobs in Flanders, Belgium"** – OECD Green Growth Studies
5. **"The United Nations: How it Works and What it Does"** – David J. Whittaker

🇧🇪 Belgium: UNHRC & Human Rights Resources 🕊️

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
Belgium elected for a term on the UN Human Rights Council (2023-2025)	https://diplomatie.belgium.be/en/news/belgium-elected-term-un-human-rights-council-2023-2025	Details Belgium's election and objectives for its term on the UNHRC.
OHCHR – Belgium Country Page	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/belgium	Overview of human rights issues and progress in Belgium.
Belgium's commitments to the Human Rights Council (2023-2025)	https://ishr.ch/wp-content/uploads/2022/06/20220613_HRCElection2023-2025_Pledge_Belgium.pdf	Outlines Belgium's pledges and commitments for its UNHRC term.
Belgium passed its universal periodic review in the working group of the UN Human Rights Council	https://international.brussels/2016/06/belgium-passed-its-universal-periodic-review-in-the-working-group-of-the-un-human-rights-council/?lang=en	Details Belgium's Universal Periodic Review process and outcomes.
Belgium - Human Rights Intergovernmental Cooperation	https://www.coe.int/en/web/human-rights-intergovernmental-cooperation/belgium	Information on Belgium's cooperation with the Council of Europe on human rights.
Human Rights Council - Elections and appointments - 72nd Session	https://www.un.org/en/ga/72/meetings/elections/hrc.shtml	Details on the election process for the UNHRC, including Belgium's participation.
UN Human Rights Council Membership - UN Research Guides	https://research.un.org/en/unmembers/hrcmembers	Information on Belgium's membership and participation in the UNHRC.
11.11.11 makes recommendations	https://11.be/en/stories/111111-makes-recommendations-for-Belgium-from-the-Human-Rights-Council	NGO recommendations

for Belgium in UN Human Rights Council		for Belgium's human rights policies.
4th UPR cycle: contributions and participation of "other stakeholders"	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/ngos-nhris	Information on NGO participation in Belgium's Universal Periodic Review.

Title	Link	Relevance
Universal Periodic Review – Belgium	OHCHR UPR documents	Core documents—reports, recommendations, state responses
OHCHR Belgium country page	OHCHR	Central hub for all UNHRC-related content
UPR Working Group – Belgium (4th cycle)	OHCHR session	Latest mid-term review, latest recommendations
<u>Disability rights – Belgium (CRPD 3rd CO)</u>	UN CRPD PDF	Highlights issues and recommendations
Gender equality – Belgium (CEDAW 7th CO)	UN CEDAW PDF	Evaluates women's rights progress
Refugee reception & rights in Belgium	Belgian government FAQ	Official guidance for asylum seekers
Unaccompanied minors – legal protections	UN Committee report PDF	Insights from the European Commission
Xenophobia & hate crimes	Amnesty International article	On racial discrimination
Prisoner rights – overcrowding	Penal Reform report PDF	Civil society evaluation
Judiciary independence review	European Commission PDF	Rule of law and judicial assessments
LGBT rights evaluation	ILGA-Europe report PDF	Civil rights of LGBTI people
Sexual and reproductive rights	Amnesty article	Analysis of legal amendments
War crimes & accountability	UN Human Rights Office commentary	Belgium's obligations under international law
Environmental rights – pollution concerns	Greenpeace Belgium report PDF	Right to a clean environment

Detention of vulnerable migrants	Human Rights Watch report PDF	Covers deprivation of liberty
Elderly rights in care homes	Age Platform Europe PDF	Elder abuse & safeguarding issues
Transport & disability access	Belgian Federal Mobility report PDF	Right to accessible services

Unique Aspects of Belgium's Engagement

1. **Multilingual inclusion** in UPR & treaty body documents (Dutch, French, German)—reflecting its federal identity.
2. **Refugee response to Ukraine conflict**—rapid policy adaptation and community sponsorship programs.
3. **Leading digital rights advocacy**—emphasis on privacy and freedom of expression in the digital age.
4. **Progressive abortion law reform** recognized by UN reviews.
5. **Counter-terrorism frameworks** under scrutiny for civil liberties tensions.
6. **Civil society's active role**, with NGOs like Human Rights League contributing peer-shadow reports.
7. **Attention to migrant detention**—HRW and UN experts highlight legal safeguards.
8. **Etical AI and environmental justice emerging**—Belgium is recognized for emerging policies on green rights.